

UNIT 02

SHAH ABDUL LATIF

WORDS AND MEANING

S. #	Words	Meaning in English	Meaning in Urdu
1.	Acceptable	Capable of being accepted or approved; satisfactory.	
2.	Admiration	A feeling of respect, approval, or deep appreciation for someone or something	
3.	Ancestral	Relating to or inherited from one's ancestors or family lineage	
4.	Atmosphere	The prevailing mood, feeling, or environment of a place	
5.	Celebrate	To observe or commemorate with festivities, joy, or ceremony	
6.	Commence	To begin or start	
7.	Compose	To create or write, especially in a literary or musical form	
8.	Compile	To gather or collect information or data from various sources and put them together in a structured form	
9.	Delicate	Fragile, easily damaged, or requiring careful handling; sensitive or subtle	
10.	Devotees	Ardent followers or enthusiasts of a particular person, belief, or activity	
11.	votion	Deep love, loyalty, or dedication, particularly in a religious or spiritual sense.	
12.	Dignity	the state or quality of being worthy of honour or respect.	
13.	Distant	Far away in space or time; remote or not closely related.	
14.	Dome	A rounded vault forming the roof of a building or structure	
15.	Domestic	Relating to or pertaining to the home, household, or one's own country.	
16.	Elegant	Graceful, stylish, or tasteful in appearance or manner.	
17.	Extent	The degree, scope, or range to which something extends or reaches	
18.	Grand	Impressive or magnificent in size, scale, or scope; noble or dignified	
19.	Impressed	To have made a strong, lasting, or favorable impact on someone's mind or emotions	

20.	Lovingly	With affection, tenderness, or deep care	
21.	Mausoleuan	A large, stately tomb or building, often containing the remains of a notable person or a revered figure	
22.	Mound	A rounded mass or heap of earth or other material	
23.	Mystic	Relating to mysteries, secret knowledge, or spiritual experiences beyond ordinary human comprehension	
24.	Navigation	The process or activity of planning and directing the course of a ship, aircraft, or other vehicle, typically over a body of water or through the air	
25.	Oral	Pertaining to spoken language or verbal communication, rather than written or signed forms	
26.	Pious	Devoutly religious, characterized by reverence or sincere devotion to religious principles.	
27.	Praise	To express approval, admiration, or commendation for someone or something	
28.	Prosperous	Successful, thriving, or experiencing financial or material well-being	
29.	Reflect	To think deeply or carefully about something; to consider or contemplate	
30.	Renowned	Widely celebrated, famous, or well-known for something	
31.	Restless	Widely known or famous for something	
32.	Reverence	Deep respect or admiration for someone or something	
33.	Saint	A person recognized for exceptional holiness or virtue	
34.	Sensitive	Easily affected by or responsive to emotions, impressions, or stimuli	
35.	Shrine	A place regarded as holy or sacred, typically housing a religious relic or statu	
36.	Spiritual	Relating to the soul, religious matters, or the non-material aspects of life.	
37.	Tender	Showing gentleness, kindness, or affection	
38.	Traditions	Customs, beliefs, or practices passed down from generation to generation	
39.	Verses	Lines of poetry or song	

40.	Abundance	A large quantity or supply of something; plenty	
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QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

Q.1: How was information regarding Shah Latif's early life collected? What was the reason for collecting it in this manner?

Ans: Details about Shah Bhitai's early life were primarily gathered through oral traditions. Mirza Kalich Beg, a well-known Pakistani scholar, educationist, and writer, is said to have collected information about Shah Bhitai's early life from elderly individuals who had heard these accounts from their ancestors. Some of these individuals had personally witnessed Shah Latif and even had conversations with him.

Q.2: Why is Shah Latif known as the 'Saint of Bhit'?

Ans: The term 'Bhit' refers to a mound of sand in the Sindhi language. After the passing of his father and wife, Shah Latif left his home and spent the remainder of his life on a mound near his village. Due to this, he is referred to as the 'Saint of Bhit' or 'Bhitai'.

Q.3: What was the reason behind Shah Latif's decision to not remarry after the death of his wife?

Ans: Shah Latif chose not to remarry after the death of his wife because his focus shifted more towards religion and devotion. He became restless and found it challenging to live a conventional domestic life, as his heart became increasingly inclined towards spirituality.

Q.4: Why did people become followers of Shah Latif?

Ans: Shah Latif's love for God grew to such an extent that he found solace only in devotion. Consequently, he dedicated a significant amount of time to prayer and deep contemplation. Through his prayers and devotion, his spiritual power became stronger, and people started to be drawn to him. Anyone who approached him was deeply influenced by his gentle demeanor, which led to a steady increase in his followers.

Q.5: What does Shah Latif's poetry and work indicate about his knowledge and skills?

Ans: Despite receiving limited formal education, the Risalo provides evidence that Shah Latif possessed a good command of Arabic and Persian. Various references in Shah jo Risalo demonstrate his in-depth knowledge of the Holy Quran and the Hadiths. His poetic collections also included the Masnavi of Moulana Jalaluddin Rumi and the poems of Shah Karim.

Q.6: Identify the places mentioned in Shah Latif's poetry. Why do you think he mentioned these places?

Ans: The places mentioned in Shah Latif's poetry include Istanbul, China, Samarkand, Rome, Kabul, Kandahar, Delhi, and Deccan. These places might have been mentioned because Shah Latif had either visited them or because they held prominence during that era.

Q.7: What makes Shah Latif's key message in his verses universally acceptable?

Ans: Shah Latif's spiritual and mystic poetry conveys a message of love, which makes it universally acceptable to all of humanity.

Q.8: Is it possible to put Shah Latif's message into practice in today's world? If so, how? If not, why not?

Ans: Yes, it is possible to implement Shah Latif's message in today's world. We can strive to foster brotherhood and equality among ourselves and seek to please God through virtuous actions. This should be the purpose of our lives in the present world, as love and brotherhood are more crucial than ever before.

Q.9: When and where was Shah Abdul Latif born? From where did his ancestors migrate?

Ans: Shah Abdul Latif was born on 689 A.D/14th Safar 1102 A.H. in a small village called 'Hala Haveli'. According to some historians, Shah's ancestors migrated to Sindh from Hirat (Afghanistan).

Q.10: How would you describe the nature of Shah Abdul Latif?

Ans: Shah Abdul Latif was a highly sensitive individual. His heart was filled with love for God, and he was deeply moved by the beauty of nature. He started writing poetry at a very young age.

Q.11: When and whom did Shah Latif marry? When did his wife pass away?

Ans: Shah Latif married Bibi Saidha Begum in 1713. Unfortunately, his wife passed away at a young age before they could have any children.

Q.12: Why did Shah Abdul Latif often sit on the bank of the lake near the mound?

Ans: Shah Latif enjoyed the peace and tranquility of the surroundings. He would spend a significant amount of time sitting on the bank of the lake, offering prayers to God and occasionally composing verses in praise of God.

Q.13: What are the notable qualities of Shah Latif's poetry?

Ans: Shah Latif's poetry is characterized by its simplicity and moving melodies. He wrote his poetry in the language of the common people.

Q.14: What message does Shah Latif convey to us through his poetry?

Ans: Shah Latif's message revolves around love, brotherhood, equality of humanity, and seeking the pleasure of God through good deeds. According to him, these should be the ultimate goals in life. He conveys this message through his poetry, which resonates with the common people.

Q.15: Write a brief description of Shah Latif's shrine.

Ans: A revered king of Sindh, Ghulam Shah Kalhoro, held deep devotion for Shah Latif, leading him to construct a magnificent mausoleum over Shah Latif's grave. The grand shrine features a beautiful white dome symbolizing the purity and dignity of Shah Latif.

Q.16: How were Shah Abdul Latif's poems collected?

Ans: Shah Latif's devotees compiled his poetry into a collection known as 'Shah Jo Risalo.' This collection expresses love, brotherhood, equality of humanity, and seeking the pleasure of God. Shah Latif's poetry is simple yet profound, and it has been translated into numerous languages due to its immense value.

Q.17: How many aspects of Shah Abdul Latif's life are covered in the text? List or name these aspects.

Ans: The text covers seven aspects of Shah Abdul Latif's life, namely:

1. Background and Family
2. Name Bhitai
3. Early Life and Education
4. Youth
5. Spiritual Growth
6. Death and Remembrance
7. Poetry

Q.18: What do you know about Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai's poetry?

Ans: Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai was a poet who wrote in the language of the common people. His poetry is characterized by simplicity and moving melodies. He mainly wrote about Sindh and its neighboring regions, conveying a message of love, brotherhood, equality, and seeking the pleasure of God. His poetry holds universal appeal and has been translated into various international languages.